FIGHTERBASE

Balanced

Diet guide

A bit of everything, in sensible portions.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Balanced**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Balanced?

No food groups cut out. Meals are built from protein, carbs, veg and some fat, with treats kept occasional. The style most sports nutrition guidance starts from.

Where it comes from

There is no single inventor. Most national healthy-eating guides (for example the NHS Eatwell Guide) describe the same shape: plenty of vegetables, fruit and starchy carbs, some protein, some dairy or alternatives, and small amounts of fat, sugar and salt.

The main ideas

1. Build most meals from four parts: a protein, a starchy carb, vegetables or fruit, and a little fat.
2. No food group is cut out and no food is banned.
3. Treats and takeaways are part of life, just not most of the week.
4. Drink mostly water, tea and coffee without sugar.
5. Eat regularly enough that you are not starving by evening.

Who it suits

- People who want something easy to stick to
- Families eating together
- People starting out who want a base before trying anything stricter

Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:

- You have a medical condition, allergy or intolerance that changes what you can eat
- You are pregnant or breastfeeding
- You are under 18 and training heavily (a coach or GP can point you to a sports dietitian)

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Put carbs (rice, pasta, potatoes, oats, bread, fruit) around harder sessions and a lighter plate on rest days.
- Aim for a protein food at every meal, and a proper meal or snack with protein and carbs within a couple of hours of training.
- Eat a meal 2 to 3 hours before training, or a small carb snack closer to the session if you are short of time.
- Drink water through the day. Check urine colour: pale straw is a good sign.

> Carbs (rice, oats, potatoes, fruit) before and after harder sessions, protein in each meal, and a proper meal within a couple of hours of training.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Protein
repairs muscle after hard sessions
Where: meat, fish, eggs, dairy, beans, tofu

Carbohydrate
fuels hard rounds and recovery
Where: rice, potatoes, oats, bread, pasta, fruit

Iron
carries oxygen; low iron means tiredness
Where: red meat, beans, lentils, dark greens, fortified cereal

Calcium and vitamin D
bones, especially with impact sport
Where: dairy or fortified alternatives, oily fish, sunlight, a supplement in winter (UK advice)

Common mistakes

- Skipping breakfast and lunch, then overeating at night
- Drinking calories (juice, fizzy drinks, large sweet coffees)
- Under-eating protein
- Treating 'balanced' as 'anything goes' every day

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Added sugar: sucrose, glucose syrup, fructose, honey, dextrose
- High salt: more than 1.5 g salt per 100 g is high
- Saturated fat: more than 5 g per 100 g is high (UK traffic-light labels)

Eating out

- Pick a grilled or roasted protein, a starchy side and a vegetable side.
- Ask for sauces on the side.
- Share a dessert or skip it midweek.
- Water first, then decide on a drink.

Easy swaps

Fizzy drink	→	Sparkling water with lemon or a sugar-free version
Crisps	→	Nuts, fruit or popcorn
White bread	→	Wholemeal or seeded bread
Fried chips	→	Oven chips or roast potatoes

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Porridge, banana, milk	Chicken salad sandwich, fruit	Salmon, potatoes, broccoli
Tue	Eggs on toast, tomatoes	Tuna pasta salad	Beef stir-fry with noodles
Wed	Greek yoghurt, berries, granola	Lentil soup and bread	Chicken, rice and peppers
Thu	Wholegrain cereal and milk	Jacket potato with beans and cheese	Turkey burgers, wedges, salad
Fri	Omelette and toast	Chicken wrap, apple	Cod, new potatoes, peas
Sat	Pancakes with fruit and yoghurt	Soup and a cheese toastie	Pasta bolognese, side salad
Sun	Full breakfast (eggs, beans, tomatoes, toast)	Leftovers bowl	Roast dinner with plenty of veg

Snacks

Fruit and a handful of nuts · Yoghurt · Oatcakes with peanut butter · Boiled eggs · Rice cakes with banana · Hummus and carrots

Shopping list

Oats, rice, pasta, potatoes, wholemeal bread · Chicken, mince, fish, eggs, tinned tuna · Milk, yoghurt, cheese · Tinned tomatoes, beans, lentils · Frozen and fresh vegetables, fruit · Olive oil, nuts, seeds

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Do I need to count calories?

No. Plate shape and regular meals are enough for most people. Counting can help for a few weeks to see your pattern.

Is a cheat day allowed?

There is nothing to cheat on. Planned treats are part of it. If one meal turns into a day of eating everything, aim to get back to normal at the next meal.

Further reading

NHS Eatwell Guide; British Dietetic Association (BDA) food facts.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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